

NEW DOORS AND GATEWAYS

Bronze and Iron Entrances for Homes of New York Millionaires.

ARTISTIC entrances to some of the finest houses in New York show remarkable instances of the modern development of art applied to industrial progress. The cheapening processes of manufacturing metal ornaments for interior and exterior decorations, and the art of working these up into elaborate and tasteful designs, have revolutionized architects' methods of constructing public and private buildings in recent years. To-day there are far more successful attempts to utilize bronze, brass, wrought iron, and other metals for decorating the entrances to homes than ever before in the history of the world.

From time immemorial bronze and brass memorial gates and doors have been designed at great expense for public buildings. But few thought of adopting even imitations of these for ordinary houses. Yet to-day the fashion is increasing to make the doors or gateways of mansions in cities imposing and beautiful with artistic metal work.

In New York the bronze doors and gates are now being made for the whole country. These are designed and manufactured right in the heart of the busiest part of the metropolis, and then shipped to their destination.

Gates and doors of metal with the most elaborate designs have been made here for private houses in Chicago, St. Louis, San Francisco, Baltimore, and other cities. Architectural skill is continually employed in furnishing designs and types of metal doors and gates, and the novelties made for one year may be eclipsed by those for the following. The designing and constructing of such elaborate pieces represent a distinct branch of architecture, which stands almost alone. The nearest approach to it is that of manufacturing memorial and ornamental windows of stained glass, which artists toil over for years at a time.

Some of the most ornate entrances are found in the mansions on Fifth Avenue and Riverside Drive. The fronts of these houses are costly in the extreme, and they are so different in pattern and type that no description or illustration of one would apply to another.

A dozen years ago the iron fence and gateway were practically unknown in New York, but many of the modern mansions are adopting this form of outside barrier and ornament. Where the building plot is large enough to warrant the construction of an iron fence, it is generally built to-day, partly for the imposing gate effect which can be obtained and partly for the development of a general architectural design of the whole structure.

An imposing wrought iron fence, ornamented with bronze relief effects, electric lights, and panels of other metals, certainly adds dignity to a large city mansion. A few of the old city homes in New York have wrought iron fences around them, built in the days when every piece had to be brought from abroad. They are in keeping with the old mansions, but they do not approach in beauty of design and effect those which are now being made in this country for the new houses.

The home of the late C. P. Huntington on Fifth Avenue, at Fifty-seventh Street, has one of the most imposing entrances in the city. The gateway is supported by three huge pillars of granite, with twin gates of fancy wrought iron swinging between them. The designs of the gates are elaborate and artistic, and the scroll of iron arching over the gates is classical in taste and designs. The columns of granite are

handsomely carved and ornamented with metal plates and scrolls. Lanterns ornament the upper part of the columns, and when lighted they furnish a soft, radiant light which greatly enhances the effect of the entrance.

At Fifth Avenue and Sixty-first Street is the home of Commodore Eibridge T. Gerry, which takes a form of artistic entrance unlike any other in the city. A wrought iron inclosure has been built in the most elaborate style, with huge plate glass panels fitted in the iron frame work, and the whole decorated with the finest products of artistic metal work.

The heavy doors, which open into this outer entrance to the house are of glass, iron, and bronze. Elaborate hinges of bronze hold the doors in position, while the iron and plate glass are woven after patterns as delicate as silver work. Overhanging the entrance to the elaborate doors are lanterns which shed a subdued light over the place at night. The plate glass and bronze trimmings then shine and reflect the light in a most brilliant way.

The Villard house, at Madison Avenue and Fiftieth Street, is inclosed in an iron fence and gateway which represent some of the quaintest and richest designs in the world. There is a square courtyard inside. The gateway is always open, but the arch of iron work over the entrance is beautifully decorated with scroll work and a handsome pendant lantern. The whole effect is pleasing to the eye as one passes up the avenue.

The old Havemeyer mansion, on the same avenue, is another instance of an iron fence and twin gates shutting off the private entrance to the house itself. The fence is an unusually high one, and the gates and posts are heavy and solid in appearance, and rich and classic in design and execution. Four lanterns on posts surmount the gates. They stand out as beacons at night, spreading a strong light upon the elaborate scroll work of iron fence and gate, and casting a dim, soft shadow upon the glass vestibule of the house entrance inside.

On Riverside Drive there are some of the best modern effects in iron fences, gateways, and bronze doors. At Eighty-ninth Street a handsome residence of white stone and marble is inclosed by one of the finest and most extensive iron fences in the country. The gate is a handsome structure of iron and brass trimmings, artistically woven into a design copied after a famous European gate. Inside of the iron fence there are handsome iron lanterns and pillars containing urns for flowers and lights. The extent of the metal work and the coloring of it all form a fitting foreground for the handsome residence in the back.

A few blocks below this on Riverside Drive is another residence shut out from intruders by an iron gate and fence, with lanterns suspended from the arches overhead.

The Cornelius Vanderbilt house displays an elaborate fence and much ornamental metal work. Newer specimens of such work are to be seen further up Fifth Avenue, many of them being of exceeding delicacy.

London can show nothing of this kind comparable to New York. The gates of Devonshire House, Piccadilly, are the most conspicuous in the British metropolis, but when examined it will be seen that their principal value is in their antiquity, not in their beauty. On the Continent there are some fine gates and fences to town houses, but none better than New York millionaires are purchasing to-day.